

L7 Real-World Application

Rebuilt from scratch. The original offered generic advice. This version provides a specific transfer design methodology.

Pillar	Learning	Difficulty	Level 2
Time Required	40-50 minutes	Group Size	4-10
Mode	Team facilitation	Format	In-person or remote
Prerequisites	L1 (Skills Diagnostic) and active learning underway	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Learning doesn't translate to real-world application, low engagement in learning programs, skills developed in training but not visible in work

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

The gap between learning and doing is called the transfer problem, and it is the single biggest waste in corporate training. Research consistently shows that without deliberate transfer design, less than 20% of learning content is applied in the workplace. The brain stores training knowledge in episodic memory ("I learned this in a workshop") rather than procedural memory ("I do this automatically in my work"). Transfer design moves learning from episodic to procedural.

The brain encodes skills through deliberate practice, not through exposure. Watching a video on negotiation skills does not develop negotiation skills. Practising negotiation with real feedback does. The 70-20-10 model reflects this neuroscience: 70% of learning happens through experience, 20% through social interaction, and 10% through formal training. Most learning investment goes into the 10% that produces the least transfer.

IF A TEAM MEMBER ASKS "WHY ARE WE DOING THIS?"

"Most of what people learn in training never makes it into their actual work. This exercise bridges that gap by identifying specific, real opportunities to apply new skills in the work we're already doing."

The Exercise

Phase 1: The Learning-Doing Gap Audit (10 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"Think about everything you've learned in the past 6 months. Training, courses, workshops, reading, coaching. How much of it have you actually applied in your work? Be honest. Write down what you

learned and, next to each item, whether you've used it."

The gap is usually stark. People recall 5-10 learning experiences but identify 1-2 where they applied the content. This is not a personal failure; it is a transfer design failure. Name it as such.

Phase 2: Application Mapping (15 minutes)

For each priority gap from L1, create a specific application plan:

Skill	Current Project	Specific Application	When	How I'll Know It Worked
<i>[From L1]</i>	<i>[Real work]</i>	<i>[Exact task]</i>	<i>[This week]</i>	<i>[Observable result]</i>

The "Specific Application" and "When" columns must be concrete. "Use communication skills in meetings" is not an application. "Use the SBI feedback framework in Thursday's 1:1 with Sarah" is an application.

Phase 3: Implementation Intentions (10 minutes)

Research on implementation intentions (Gollwitzer, 1999) shows that framing plans as "When X happens, I will do Y" doubles follow-through compared to general intentions.

WHAT TO SAY

"For your most important application, frame it as a when-then plan: 'When [specific trigger situation], I will [specific new behaviour].' Write it on a card. Put it somewhere you'll see it."

Examples:

- "When I'm about to send a complex email, I will apply the three-point simplification from C11."
- "When a team member raises a problem in standup, I will practise active listening for 60 seconds before responding."
- "When I finish a task, I will write two sentences in my learning journal before moving to the next one."

Phase 4: Follow-Up Design (5 minutes)

Schedule a follow-up check-in (2-4 weeks out) where each person reports: did you apply it? What happened? What would you do differently? This closes the loop and makes the application visible to the team.

Facilitation Notes

Situation	Response
Applications are vague or generic	Push for specificity: "Which project? Which meeting? Which day? If you can't name the context, the brain won't activate the skill when the moment arrives." Vague applications produce zero transfer.
Someone says they have no opportunity to apply what they're learning	Two possibilities: the learning is not relevant to their current work (revisit L1 and L4), or they don't recognise the opportunities (help them map: "Tell me about your next week. Where could this skill show up?"). The second is more common.

Signs This Is Working

Timeframe	What to Look For
During the session	Application maps are specific and connected to real work Implementation intentions feel concrete, not aspirational People can identify the trigger situation for their when-then plan
Within 2-4 weeks	At least one person reports successfully applying a new skill The follow-up check-in produces real stories of application (and productive stories of failed application) Someone says "I used the thing we practised"
CLOVER ERA data (4-6 weeks)	Learning scores increase Qualitative data references applying, using, or practising new skills Productivity-related indicators may improve as applied skills produce results

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
L1: Skills Diagnostic	L7 applies the priority gaps identified in L1 to real work.	Run L1 before L7
L2: Peer-to-Peer Learning	Peer sessions produce knowledge; L7 converts it to application. The follow-up check-in in L2 is a lightweight version of L7.	Complementary
L6: Accountability	L6 holds people accountable; L7 provides the specific application targets to be accountable for.	Run together
R2: From Ideas to Action	R2 addresses the broader challenge of converting insight into behaviour change. L7 is the learning-specific version.	Complementary